

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

Ps Barry's Reflections on: **PRAYER, PROCLAMATION and PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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For our first reflections for 2025 I thought it might be helpful to present some facts about early missionaries to the Pacific islands and also other nations which might be new to you and to see what might be learned from them.

Note: That being qualified for missionary service means more than just educational and work qualifications: it also means the inner qualities (character) of the person.

Firstly, I thought it could be helpful to understand the following facts about the calibre of the 19th century missionaries that came to pioneer the Islands of the Pacific (ocean)

Is there some valuable lesson that we can take from them?

LET US LOOK AT THE CALIBRE OF THE NINETEENTH CENTURY MISSIONARIES. **We can possibly learn something from them.**

"From an academic point of view they represented a wide spectrum, all the way from semi-literate artisans to university graduates.

AN ARTISAN is a worker in a skilled trade, especially one that involves making things by hand.

"The Missionaries from Germany and Scotland were much better trained, many of them being university men.

"The same was true of the men from the United States.

Most of them were graduates of the finest colleges and seminaries on the East Coast, and they established some of the most prestigious educational institutions on the mission field, especially in the Middle and Far East.

"On the other hand, the Missionaries from England were not so well educated.

"From 1815 to 1891 the Church Missionary Society sent out 650 missionaries, of whom only 240 were college graduates. Moreover, most of them were laymen not ordained ministers.

"The first band of London Missionary Society missionaries sailed for the South Seas in 1796. There were thirty in the party; only four of them ordained, the rest were artisans."

WHAT ABOUT THEIR SPIRITUAL QUALITIES?

"What they have lacked by way of intellectual prowess **they made up for in Christian character.**"

Almost without exception, the missionaries of the nineteenth century were men and women of **deep conviction and compassion.**

They believed that the heathen was lost without a knowledge of Jesus Christ. They spared no pains to take the Gospel to the lost and dying "before it was too late".

Pearl Buck daughter of missionaries to China:

The early missionaries were born warriors and very great men, for in those days religion was still a banner under which to fight.

No weak or timid soul could sail the seas to foreign lands and defy death and danger unless he did carry religion as his banner; under which even death itself would be a glorious end.

To go forth, to cry out, to warn, to save others, these were frightful urgencies upon the soul already saved. There was a very madness of necessity - an agony of salvation.

So, you see that being qualified means more than just educational and work qualifications: it also means the inner qualities (character) of the person.

Some points noted from above as being of vital importance for us to remember and also with respect to all those who are engaged in training, mentoring and making disciples of today's students.

CHRISTIAN CHARACTER

"What they have lacked by way of intellectual prowess they made up for in Christian character."

Developing Character as a first priority

Character is of more important than knowledge

Character before charisma

THIS SHOULD BE OUR AIM IN PRODUCING DISCIPLE

CONVICTION AND COMPASSION

Almost without exception, the missionaries of the nineteenth century were men and women of **deep conviction and compassion.**

CONVICTION Is a deeply held opinion or belief that remains unchanged by life's circumstances and events.

COMPASSION is concern, care, kindness, consideration and empathy.

More than any other quality in our lives should be compassion.

Jesus was moved with Compassion on the multitudes.

Pharaoh's daughter was moved with compassion at seeing the baby Moses in the basket – and thus determined the ultimate destiny of God's people Israel.

MAN LOST WITHOUT CHRIST

THEY BELIEVED THAT THE HEATHEN WAS LOST WITHOUT A KNOWLEDGE OF JESUS CHRIST.

SUCH A CONVICTION SEEMS TO BE LOST AMONGST MANY CHRISTIANS TODAY.

A CONVICTION IS TOO DEFINITIVE, TOO RESTRICTIVE TO HOLD TO EVEN THOUGH THE SCRIPTURES TEACH THAT FAILURE TO BELIEVE IN CHRIST JESUS MEANS ETERNAL SEPARATION FROM GOD (DEATH AND HELL).

THEY SPARED NOTHING IN ORDER TO ACTIVELY ENGAGE THEMSELVES IN CHRIST'S GLOBAL CAUSE.

They spared no pains to take the Gospel to the lost and dying "before it was too late".

THIS CONVICTION WAS THE SOLE MOTIVATING FORCE THAT DROVE THOSE EARLY MISSIONARIES TO COMMIT THEMSELVES TO THE TASK OF MAKING CHRIST KNOWN THROUGHOUT THE WHOLE EARTH.

Things learned from the lives of the early missionaries

- 1. THEY HAD CHRISTIAN CHARACTER**
- 2. THEY HAD COMPASSION, CARE, CONCERN AND EMPATHY FOR OTHERS**
- 3. THEY WERE IMPACTED BY THEIR DEEP CONVICTION**
- 4. THEY BELIEVED EXPLICITLY THAT WITHOUT ACCEPTANCE OF CHRIST AND HIM ALONE FOR SALVATION THEN MAN IS DESTINED TO AN ETERNITY WITHOUT GOD**
- 5. THEY GAVE THEMSELVES UNSELFISHLY TO GO TO THE HEATHEN NATIONS OF THE WORLD TO MAKE CHRIST KNOWN.**

WHAT AN EXAMPLE FOR US TO FOLLOW -TO IMITATE

Amen – Pastor Barry